Support Escalation and Troubleshooting Guide

When to escalate

Escalate only after the basic checks fail, or at once if the issue is urgent.

Try first, then escalate if still broken:

- I can reproduce the problem, or have a screenshot or recording of it
- I checked the client's settings, permissions and connected accounts
- I checked whether it affects one contact or many
- I tried the fix steps below at least once
- I searched the help center or my notes for the same issue

Escalate immediately if:

- Leads or messages are being lost, or payments are affected
- The client cannot log in or the whole account is down
- Client data may be exposed or shown to the wrong person
- The issue affects several clients at once

Troubleshooting routine

1. Define the problem in one sentence: what should happen, and what happens instead.
2. Ask when it started and what changed just before: a new setting, integration, user or import.
3. Reproduce it. Try the same action yourself, then try it with a different contact or user.
4. Narrow the scope: one contact, one calendar, one pipeline, or the whole account.
5. Check the basics: user permissions, time zone, connected email or phone, and whether the item is active or paused.
6. Check the logs or history if the platform shows them, such as message status, workflow history or booking details.
7. Try one fix at a time and retest after each, so you know which change worked.
8. If it is still broken, stop and write the escalation post using the template below.

Escalation post template

Title: [Short summary: what is broken, for whom]

Urgency: [Low / Medium / High / Urgent] because [reason]

Client / account: [name or ID]

Pipeline stage or area affected: [e.g. Appointment Booked, calendar, workflow]

First noticed: [date and time, time zone]

Who is affected: [one contact / several / whole account]

Expected result:

[What should happen]

Actual result:

[What happens instead, with any error message copied exactly]

Steps to reproduce:

1.

2.

3.

What I already checked or tried:

- [check or fix] -> [result]
- [check or fix] -> [result]

Evidence:

[Screenshot or recording link]

What I need from you:

[A fix, a decision, or information]

Client has been told: [yes/no, and what]

Pipeline stage map

Pipeline stage	Support scenario	First checks
New Lead	Form submissions do not create a contact	Form is connected to the right pipeline; contact is not a duplicate; submission appears in the form log
New Lead	Lead received no automatic reply	Automation is active; contact has a valid email or phone; message status shows sent or failed
Contacted	Client cannot see a lead's message history	User permissions; the conversation is assigned to a user; correct sub-account
Appointment Booked	Booking shows the wrong time	Time zone on calendar, user and contact; daylight saving settings
Appointment Booked	Customer cannot book a slot	Availability, buffers, meeting limits and whether the calendar is active

Pipeline stage	Support scenario	First checks
Proposal Sent	Document or invoice link is not delivered	Email deliverability; spam folder; link permissions
Won / Lost	Lead did not move stage automatically	Automation trigger and filters; the contact meets every condition
Any stage	Opportunity missing from the pipeline	Filters on the view; opportunity status; assigned user

Worked example 1 (mock scenario)

This is an invented case for practice, not a real client.

Title: Booked appointments show 5 hours earlier than the customer selected

Urgency: High because customers may miss appointments

Client / account: Sample Dental Clinic (mock)

Pipeline stage or area affected: Appointment Booked, main booking calendar

First noticed: Mon 9:30 AM, client's local time

Who is affected: All new bookings since Monday

Expected result:

A customer who books 2:00 PM sees and receives 2:00 PM.

Actual result:

The confirmation email and calendar entry show 9:00 AM.

Steps to reproduce:

1. Open the public booking page.
2. Choose Thursday at 2:00 PM and submit.
3. Check the confirmation email and the calendar entry.

What I already checked or tried:

- User profile time zone -> set to the clinic's correct zone
- Calendar time zone -> was set to a different zone; corrected, retested, still wrong in the email
- Contact record time zone -> blank
- Test booking from a second device -> same result

Evidence:

[Screenshot of the email and the calendar entry]

What I need from you:

Check where the confirmation email takes its time zone from.

Client has been told: Yes. Told them we are investigating and to confirm times by phone this week.

Worked example 2 (mock scenario)

This is another invented case for practice, not a real client.

Title: Website form leads are not appearing in the pipeline

Urgency: Urgent because new leads are being lost

Client / account: Sample Fitness Studio (mock)

Pipeline stage or area affected: New Lead stage, website contact form

First noticed: Wed afternoon, found while checking the weekly report

Who is affected: All website form submissions since Tuesday evening

Expected result:

Each form submission creates a contact and an opportunity in New Lead.

Actual result:

The client received 6 notification emails, but no new contacts or opportunities appear.

Steps to reproduce:

1. Submit the live website form with a test name and email.
2. Check the Contacts list and the New Lead column after a few minutes.

What I already checked or tried:

- Form submissions log -> test entry is recorded
- Form is attached to the correct pipeline -> yes
- Duplicate contact check -> test email is new
- Workflow that creates the opportunity -> history shows an error on the last step
- Re-saved and republished the workflow -> same error on a new test

Evidence:

[Screenshot of the workflow history error and the form log]

What I need from you:

Explain the workflow error and confirm whether the 6 missed leads can be recovered.

Client has been told: Yes. Told them leads are safe in the form log and we will add them manually while this is fixed.

Client update template

Hi [Name],

Thanks for flagging this. Here is where things stand:

- What we found: [one plain sentence]
- What it affects: [what the client will notice]
- What we have done: [steps taken]
- What happens next: [who is looking at it and what they will do]
- What you can do meanwhile: [a workaround, if there is one]

I will update you by [specific day and time], even if there is no change.

Best,

Rehan

Rules for client updates

- Never blame the client or a colleague.
- Do not guess at a cause or a fix time. Say "I'll confirm and update you by [time]".
- Close the loop: when it is fixed, tell the client what was wrong and how to avoid it.